

Figure 1: Workspace launcher

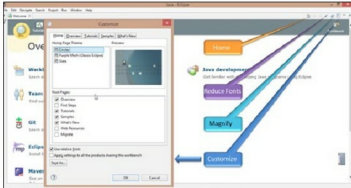


Figure 2: Eclipse 'Welcome' page

The Eclipse UI and appearance

Uncompress the downloaded Eclipse file, and click on the Eclipse icon to open a workspace launcher.

Eclipse stores your projects in a folder called a workspace, which is the location of the directory in which you save your projects, source files, images, jar files and other artifacts. Choose a workspace folder to use for this session. To avoid opening this workspace launcher all the time, you can select the checkbox 'Use this as the default and do not ask again'.

Eclipse starts up and displays the *Welcome* page, where you can customise or personalise it based on your preferences.

Click on the 'Customize' icon as shown in Figure 3 and its dialogue box will open.

To change the home page theme, click on the *Home* tab to customise the dialogue box. In the *Home Page Theme* section, select one that you would like to replace the *Welcome* screen of Eclipse.

Close the *Welcome* screen.

To change the appearance, go to

Window → *Preferences* → *General* → *Appearance* → *Select Theme* (e.g., *Classic*, *Dark*, *Windows 7*, *Windows 7 Classic*) → *Select Colour and Font theme*.

Then select the checkbox *Enable animations*.

To change the Web browser settings, go to

Window → *Preferences* → *General* → *Web Browser* → *Select 'Use Internal Web Browser'* or *'Use External Web Browser'*.

Perspective

An Eclipse perspective is an initial collection and arrangement of views and visible actions in an editor section. The default perspective in Eclipse is *Java Users*. can select

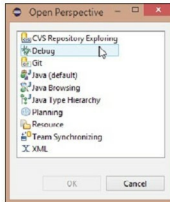


Figure 3: Eclipse Java Perspective-Luna

only one perspective at a time from the multiple options available. To change the perspective, go to *Window* → *Open Perspective* → *Select Specific Perspective*.

To see the list of all perspectives, click on *Others*. Shown in Figure 4 is the perspective in Eclipse Luna and Eclipse JEE Helio.

To change the layout within a perspective, go to *Window* → *Show View* → *Select a View of your Choice*, and that part will be added in the editor window.

You can rearrange the perspective with the use of *Views* and then save that perspective also from the 'Window' menu.

The following list is a useful summary of some useful Views available in Eclipse.

- **Package Explorer View:** Allows you to browse projects and to open in an editor.
- **Type Hierarchy View:** Provides hierarchy for a type, its subtypes, or its supertypes.
- **Call Hierarchy View:** Gives details of callers and those called for a selected Java method.
- **Java Outline View:** Displays an outline of the active Java file structure.
- **JUnit View:** Displays the progress of the JUnit test run and its status.
- **Javadoc View:** Shows the Javadoc of the element selected in the Java editor.
- **Declaration View:** Shows the source of the element selected in the Java editor.
- **Projects View:** Shows Java projects, external and internal libraries, source folders, etc.
- **Packages View:** Shows the list of Java packages from the currently selected Java projects.
- **Types View:** This is a list of Java types from the currently selected packages.
- **Members View:** Displays the contents of a type, compilation unit or CLASS file.
- **Debug View:** This is to manage the debugging or running of a program.
- **Breakpoints View:** Lists all the breakpoints.
- **Expressions View:** This is to inspect data.
- **Variables View:** Displays information about the variables associated with the stack frame selected in the *Debug View*.
- **Console View:** Displays a variety of console types.

Creating a Java project

Go to *File Menu* → *New* → *Java Project*. Give the *Project*